

a while. Disk defragmentation, for example, does not proceed if your disk has errors.

9.5.2 Chkdsk

Chkdsk is the more comprehensive, command-line version of Scandisk. It creates and displays a status report for a disk based on the file system. Chkdsk also lists and corrects errors on the disk. You run Chkdsk by opening a command prompt and typing in “chkdsk” with various switches. Used without switches, chkdsk displays the status of the disk in the current drive.

The syntax is as follows:

```
chkdsk [volume:][[Path] FileName] [/f] [/v] [/r] [/x] [/i] [/c] [/l[:size]]
```

volume: Specifies the drive letter (followed by a colon), mount point, or volume name.

[Path] FileName: Specifies the location and name of a file or set of files that you want chkdsk to check for fragmentation. You can use wildcard characters—the asterisk and the question mark—to specify multiple files.

/f: Fixes errors on the disk. The disk must be locked. If chkdsk cannot lock the drive, a message appears that asks you if you want to check the drive the next time you restart the computer.

/v: Displays the name of each file in every directory as the disk is checked.

/r: Locates bad sectors and recovers readable information. The disk must be locked.

/x: (Used only with NTFS) Forces the volume to dismount first, if necessary. All open handles to the drive are invalidated. /x also includes the functionality of /f.